

Ὀππιανὸς ὁ ἐξ Ἀπαμείας

Oppian of Apamea on the Hunt

eul_aid: rje

Period: Ῥωμαϊκὴ [Roman](#)
Dialect: Ἑπικὴ [Epic](#) (Homeric)
Domain: Ἔπος [Epic](#)
Format: Ἑμμετρος [Verse](#)

Oppian of Apamea, also known as Oppian the Younger, was a Greek didactic epic poet active in the late second or early third century CE. He is distinguished from the earlier poet Oppian of Cilicia. According to an anonymous biography, he was the son of a philosopher from Apamea in Syria and dedicated his work to Emperor Caracalla, though precise dating is complicated by ancient sources that conflate the two poets.

His sole extant work is the **Cynegetica**, a didactic epic in four books comprising roughly 2,150 verses on the hunting of wild animals. Oppian's significance rests on this poem as a major work of later Greek didactic poetry, continuing the Hellenistic tradition of the technical epic. It serves as a valuable source for ancient hunting practices, zoological knowledge, and cultural attitudes toward nature in the Roman Imperial period.

Composed in the Homeric dialect, the poem was popular in Byzantium. It is often paired with the **Halieutica** of Oppian of Cilicia, together representing the primary didactic epics on animal life from antiquity.

Works (1)

- [Κυνηγετικά](#) · [Hunting Matters](#) · 2145 passages